

WILLOWMERE PHASE 3

Winter condition survey of the depot buildings and northern boundary

1. Scope and method

This survey records the condition of the depot range and the northern boundary planting following the February cold spell. The walkover was made on foot from the nine fixed photographic points established in Phase 1, in daylight, with no access to roof level. Nothing in this report rests on measurement taken from a photograph.

Conditions were hard frost with lying snow of roughly 120 mm on level ground, which obscured the yard surfaces and the lower courses of the boundary wall. Those elements are carried forward to the spring visit rather than reported here.

2. Depot range, north elevation



Plate 3 - northern boundary planting from fixed point 4, 14 February 2026. The mature spruce at centre is outside the demise and is noted for the shading it casts on the north range rather than for its own condition.

The roof covering is sound across the visible slopes. Snow has not lifted at the verges, which would be the first sign of a failed fixing, and the valley between the two ranges is clear. Two rooflights on the eastern slope carry ice at their upstands and should be re-inspected once the thaw is complete.

Rainwater goods are the principal defect. The eastern downpipe is discharging at the hopper rather than into it, and the staining below is consistent with this having run for more than one season. Repair is straightforward and is recommended before the spring rain rather than as part of the Phase 4 works.

3. Northern boundary

The boundary planting is in good condition and is performing the screening function it was retained for. No storm damage was evident. The self-seeded ash on the eastern return has reached a size at which it will begin to lift the wall footing and should be taken out this winter while access is still open.